

Proposal for Emoji: Liver

Submitter: Shuhan He, MD

Main point of contact: Shuhan He

Date: 2026-07-09

Identification

Suggested name: Liver

Suggested keywords: hepatic; anatomy; organ; metabolism; digestion; bile; alcohol; hepatitis; transplant; donation

Suggested category: People & Body - body-parts

Suggested sort location: Near anatomical heart, lungs, and brain in the body-parts subgroup.

Required Example Images

Size	Color	Black and white
18x18		
72x72		

The paradigm uses the liver's broad, asymmetrical lobed silhouette with a small gallbladder cue. Vendors may omit the gallbladder if the liver remains recognizable. Fine surface anatomy is unnecessary at emoji scale.

The example images are original vector artwork created for this proposal and released under CC0 1.0. Editable SVG sources and the license are included in the public packet:

<https://github.com/ShuhanCS/medicalemoji/tree/feat/microsoft-round-strategy/submissions/v1.2.0/liver/images>

<https://github.com/ShuhanCS/medicalemoji/blob/feat/microsoft-round-strategy/submissions/v1.2.0/ARTWORK-LICENSE.md>

Factors for Inclusion

A. Multiple usages

Liver is a familiar body part with uses across anatomy, digestion, metabolism, health, food, testing, donation, and transplant. It supports ordinary messages about liver function, laboratory results, medication effects, alcohol, hepatitis, fatty liver, transplant, living donation, school science, animal liver as food, and family health.

The concept crosses clinical and everyday contexts. People discuss liver health when reviewing tests or medications, talking about alcohol, making diet choices, caring for relatives, learning biology, or preparing food. A liver pictograph identifies the organ directly, where hospital, pill, warning, food, or beverage emoji each show only one surrounding context.

B. Use in sequences

Liver can combine with existing emoji to create messages without standardized sequences:

- Liver + test tube or chart: liver function test or laboratory results.
- Liver + pill: medication processing, side effects, or treatment.
- Liver + warning or alcoholic drink: liver risk or alcohol-related concern.
- Liver + people or heart: donation, transplant, recipient, caregiver, or support.
- Liver + hospital: hepatology visit, procedure, or inpatient care.
- Liver + plate or cooking pot: liver as food or cooking context.
- Liver + book or microscope: anatomy, school science, or research.

C. Breaks new ground

No current emoji represents the liver or hepatic anatomy. General medical emoji represent care, tests, or treatment; food and beverage emoji represent consumption; and anatomical heart, lungs, and brain represent different organs. None can identify liver function, liver testing, liver donation, transplant, or liver-specific health discussion. Liver therefore adds a distinct internal-organ concept.

D. Distinctiveness

The liver has a broad, wedge-like, asymmetrical silhouette with unequal lobes. The proposed paradigm adds a small gallbladder cue in color and a simple lobe division in black and white. It is wider and flatter than the stomach, has no paired symmetry like kidneys or lungs, and does not resemble anatomical heart or brain. The silhouette remains legible at 18x18 without text.

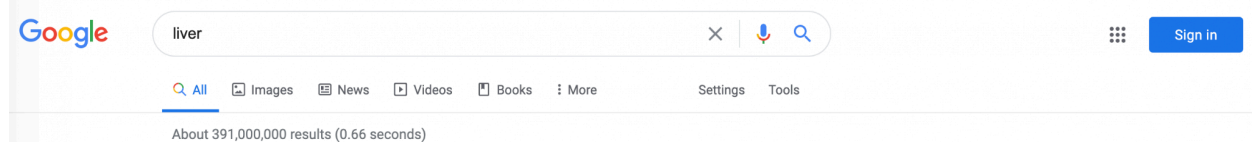
E. Expected usage level

The required evidence covers general web results, video results, long-term web interest, image-search interest, and published-book usage. Google Trends and Google Books compare `liver` with

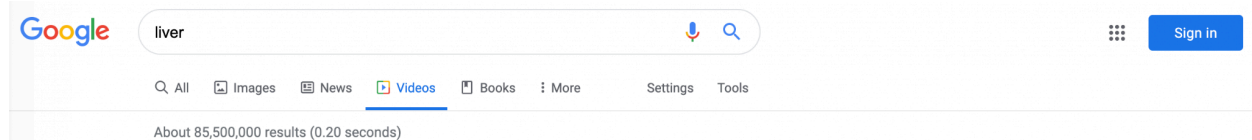
Unicode's reference term `elephant` .

Evidence	Result in included capture	Reproducible URL
Google Search	About 391,000,000 results; captured 2020-07-12	https://www.google.com/search?q=liver&hl=en&num=10&pws=0
Google Video Search	About 85,500,000 results; captured 2020-07-12	https://www.google.com/search?tbm=vid&q=liver&hl=en&num=10&pws=0
Google Trends Web Search	United States, 2004-present; liver and elephant show comparable average interest in the captured period; captured 2020-07-12	https://trends.google.com/trends/explore?date=all&geo=US&q=liver,elephant
Google Trends Image Search	United States, 2008-present; sustained liver image-search interest; captured 2020-07-12	https://trends.google.com/trends/explore?date=all_2008&geo=US&gprop=images&q=liver,elephant
Google Books Ngram Viewer	English, 1500-2022; liver substantially exceeds elephant in recent published-book usage; captured 2026-07-09	https://books.google.com/ngrams/graph?content=elephant%2Cliver&year_start=1500&year_end=2022&corpus=en&smoothing=3

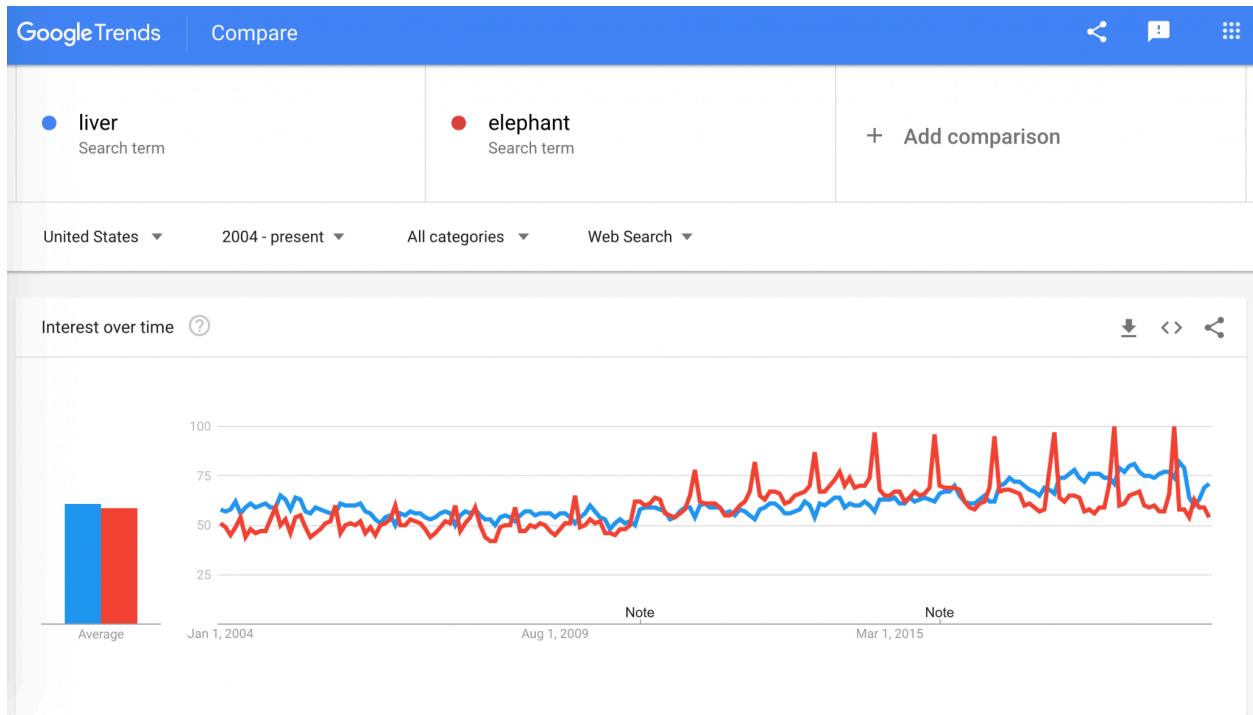
Google Search



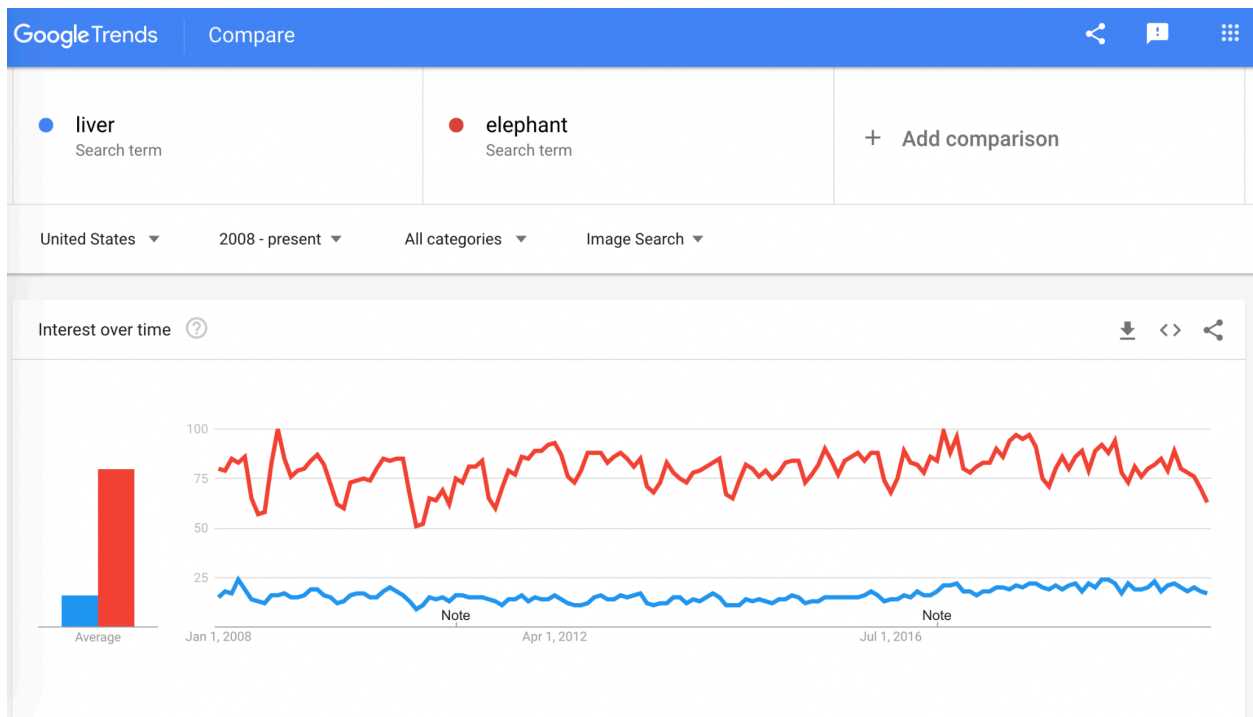
Google Video Search



Google Trends - Web Search



Google Trends - Image Search



Google Books Ngram Viewer



F. Completeness

Not applicable. Liver is independently useful and is not proposed merely to complete a set of organs.

G. Compatibility

Not applicable. This proposal does not rely on a legacy carrier emoji or another encoded pictograph.

Factors for Exclusion

A. Already represented

Liver is not represented by an existing emoji. Hospital, pill, test tube, warning, food, and beverage emoji can show surrounding contexts but cannot identify the organ or distinguish a liver-specific message.

B. Overly specific

Liver is a primary organ and a broad everyday concept, not a particular disease, procedure, specialty, organization, campaign, or brand. Its uses span anatomy, metabolism, digestion, testing, medication, alcohol, donation, transplant, food, and education.

C. Open-ended

This proposal does not request a complete anatomy taxonomy. Liver is supported by its own frequency, multiple usages, visual distinctiveness, and lack of an adequate substitute. Other organs can be judged independently on the same criteria.

D. Transient

Liver anatomy, function, testing, medication effects, alcohol, disease, donation, transplant, and food uses are durable concepts rather than a temporary event or trend.

E. Justified only by existing emoji

The proposal does not argue that liver should be encoded merely because other organs exist. Its case rests on its own expected usage, multiple meanings, recognizable silhouette, and expressive gap.

Other Information

The singular common name `Liver` is concise and searchable. Essential design cues are a broad, asymmetrical, lobed organ silhouette. A green gallbladder or lobe division can improve recognition but is optional. Vendors should avoid excessive realism and preserve a clear outline at 18x18.

Official Unicode proposal guidance:

<https://www.unicode.org/emoji/proposals.html>